Lesson plan · for the teacher

Pupils' data: collect less, protect more

Cyber security · Level 3 · Lesson 1

Time
40 min

Materials
Board and chalk; A pretend trip form with ten questions, on the board or on paper; Worksheet: Collect less (one per group, optional)

Learning goals

- Tell everyday personal data from sensitive data.
- Apply the big ideas of data protection: collect less, keep it safe.
- Find and fix the weak points in how school data is shared.

Activity: Collect less: the trip form

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the story: a teacher is about to post the whole class's results in the parents' group. Ask: would you want your mark shown to every family? Why not?
2. Teach (8 min): Write two columns on the board: personal data (name, photo, phone, marks) and sensitive data (health, religion, family money). Pupils add one example to each.
3. Trip form (15 min): Show the ten-question trip form. In groups, pupils cross out every question the trip doesn't need and circle the sensitive ones it does need. Walk around and ask each group to explain one choice.
4. Share (7 min): Each group defends one decision, for example why allergies stay. Agree as a class who should keep the forms, and when they should be destroyed.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one piece of sensitive data and one way to protect it. Read a few aloud.

Copy the ten-question trip form on the board before the lesson: name, class, a parent's phone, allergies, religion, father's job, family income, favourite food, home address, photo. Use a pretend school and no real pupils.

Discussion

- Would you want your mark shown to every family?
- Which question on the form surprised you most?
- Who should keep the trip forms, and for how long?

Exit ticket

- One piece of sensitive data + how I would protect it.

Try it at school tomorrow
Write a pretend trip form with ten questions on the board: name, class, a parent's phone, allergies, religion, father's job, family income, favourite food, home address and a photo. In groups, pupils cross out every question the trip doesn't need and explain why. Then agree who should keep the answers, and for how long.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **A sign-up form for the football club asks every family for their religion and monthly income. What should you do with those two questions?**

- ◯ Keep them, but mark them optional
- ◯ Remove them — the club doesn't need them
- ◯ Keep them — more data might be useful later

2 **Your school keeps all of these about pupils. Which are sensitive and need the most care?**

- ☐ Which pupils get free meals because of family income
- ☐ The class timetable
- ☐ A pupil's favourite sport
- ☐ A pupil's asthma and the medicine they take
- ☐ A pupil's religion on the enrolment form

3 **A results list that shows exam numbers instead of names can still be personal data.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

4 **Complete the rule.**

Collect only what you _____, keep it _____, and _____ it when you no longer need it.

Word bank: share · delete · need · public · safe

5 **Match each weak point to the habit that fixes it.**

Results posted with full names in the parents' group	• • • •	Lock it, and shred what's no longer needed
A file shared with "anyone with the link"	• • • •	Keep them in the school's own account
Old registers in an unlocked cupboard	• • • •	Send each parent only their child's result
Pupils' phone numbers in a teacher's personal email	• • • •	Share with named people only

✎ **Think of one form or list your school uses. Which question on it does the school not really need, and what would you do about it?**

Check your answers

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1 **Remove them — the club doesn't need them**

Collect only what a clear purpose needs.

2 **A pupil's asthma and the medicine they take; Which pupils get free meals because of family income; A pupil's religion on the enrolment form**

Health, family money and religion can cause real harm if they leak: bullying, unfair treatment or shame.

3 **True**

True: anyone who can link the numbers to names, such as the school office or classmates who know each other's numbers, can still identify the pupils.

4 **Collect only what you need, keep it safe, and delete it when you no longer need it.**

Need, safe, delete: the life of school data in one line.

5 **Results posted with full names in the parents' group — Send each parent only their child's result**
A file shared with "anyone with the link" — Share with named people only
Old registers in an unlocked cupboard — Lock it, and shred what's no longer needed
Pupils' phone numbers in a teacher's personal email — Keep them in the school's own account

Each fix closes one way data leaks. None of them needs money or new technology, only a habit.